5.20 The Unconscious Patient*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • GCS 7 • Snoring respirations • Pooled secretions	**ACTUAL** Ineffective airway clearance related to decreased level of consciousness as evidenced by snoring respirations and pooled secretions.	• Airway stays open.	• Nurse on the side or with the head of the bed raised. • Insert an airway adjunct if needed. • Suction as required. • Watch SpO_2.	• Met while the airway is clear.
Subjective • Family ask how they can help with care **Objective** • Cannot do any self-care • GCS 7	**ACTUAL** Decreased bathing abilities related to unconsciousness as evidenced by total dependence.	• Skin, eyes and mouth kept clean and intact.	• Give full hygiene care. • Give eye care to protect the cornea. • Give mouth care every 4 hours. • Involve the family in care if they wish.	• Achieved when skin, eyes and mouth are clean.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Immobile • Incontinent	**RISK** Risk for adult pressure injury as evidenced by risk factors: immobility and incontinence.	• Skin intact.	• Turn every 2 hours. • Clean and dry the skin after each episode of incontinence. • Use a pressure-redistributing mattress.	• Outcome reached if the skin stays intact.

* **References for this care plan:** [19], [35], [110], [124], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.